

Book II - The Spiral and the Block

Part 1 - The True Republic

Chapter 04 - Is Government Authority Real

EP01 — Is Government Authority Real?

Series: True Republic **Type:** Street / Campus Interview **Core Question:** "Is government authority real, or is it just an agreement?"

The Seed Being Planted

Most people have never distinguished between *authority* (legitimate power derived from consent) and *force* (power derived from the threat of harm). This episode lets people discover that distinction themselves through their own reasoning.

The shaken jar operates by making people fight each other over which ruler to obey — red ants vs black ants — without ever asking whether anyone has the right to shake the jar.

Interview Arc

Opening Question

"Is government authority real?"

Follow-Up Questions (based on their answer)

- "Where does that authority come from?"
- "Did you personally consent to it?"
- "If you were born somewhere else, would a different government have authority over you?"
- "So is it the government that has authority, or is it the location you were born?"
- "What's the difference between a mugger demanding your wallet and a tax collector?"

- "If it's wrong for one person to take your money by force, when does it become right for a group?"

The Contradiction That Often Emerges

People will say authority comes from "the consent of the governed" — then realize they were never personally asked. Or they'll say force makes it real — then realize that logic justifies any sufficiently powerful aggressor.

The goal is not to win the argument. It's to leave them holding the question.

Cold Open Script (Narrator, over b-roll of government buildings)

"Every civilization in history has had rulers. And every ruler has claimed their authority was legitimate. But what does that actually mean?"

Closing Narration

Connect to the shaken jar: the ants fight over which colony's rules are correct while the jar-shaker watches. The more dangerous question is not which ruler is legitimate — it's whether the institution of rulership itself requires the consent it claims.

Source Quotes

Direct quotes from Sage's own writing to draw from when scripting this episode.

"A true Republic is not a form of government or a state with the monopoly on legitimate use of force but a network of voluntary action where each individual follows their own conscience instead of arbitrary rules from human hierarchy."

"There are 100 red ants and 100 black ants in a jar. The jar is shook and the red ants think black is the enemy and the black ants think red is the enemy. But the real enemy is the one who shook the jar. The only question is: how do you unshake the jar?"

"Enforcement of an unjust law is worse than criminal because it uses the facade of fighting criminals to commit their crimes. A crime isn't breaking the worldly law scribbles — it is breaking natural law."

"Persuasion is just, but the initiation of force is not. A just society cannot be built upon coercion, for the moment force replaces reason, truth is abandoned."

"The ruler king is an agent of satan and the leader king is an agent of god. The ruler is there to be served and the leader is there to serve."

"When they created the king by force God said they have rejected me as their king."

The Living Age Trilogy